

FOOD PAIRING GUIDE: WHEATED WHISPERS

Light bites that settle the stomach and keep the whiskey in focus.

ON EVERY TABLE

Water crackers

Plain, unsalted or lightly salted (Carr's Table Water, Bremner Wafers).

Plain baguette

Unseasoned rounds. The wheat echoes the mash bill and soaks up alcohol.

Unsalted nuts

Almonds or cashews, raw or dry-roasted. No seasoning.

PAIRINGS BY EXPRESSION

1

WELLER SPECIAL RESERVE

90 PROOF

Look for: honey, soft sweetness, gentle grain.

Plain shortbread, one small piece

Mirrors the sweetness without adding flavors of its own.

2

OLD FITZGERALD 7 YEAR BOTTLED IN BOND

100 PROOF

Look for: caramel, vanilla, baking spice, firm oak.

Young Gouda, or unsalted butter on a cracker

Creamy fat softens the proof so the caramel and oak read clearly.

3

GREEN RIVER FULL PROOF WHEATED BOURBON

109.3 PROOF

Look for: richer oak, spice, a bigger and warmer pour.

Mild white cheddar or Havarti

Fat buffers the higher proof. Take a sip of water between pours.

4

HOLLADAY RICKHOUSE PROOF SOFT RED WHEAT MISSOURI STRAIGHT BOURBON

120.1 PROOF

Look for: breadly grain and soft orchard fruit.

Crisp pear slices or unsweetened dried apple

Complements the fruit and grain without overpowering them.

PLEASE SKIP

Spicy, smoked or heavily salted snacks (flavored chips, jerky, pepperoni). Pungent cheeses like blue or aged sharp cheddar. Dark chocolate and very sweet treats. Citrus, pickles, garlic and herbs.

TASTING TIPS

Nibble before and between flights, never while nosing or sipping. Keep portions small. Use the dump cup freely. Save dessert for after the last pour.

Drink plenty of water throughout the event. A glass between every pour keeps the palate fresh and the evening long.